under arrest … for having attacked police and IDF officers, not for harming Palestinians, God forbid.

Monday, February 27

On March 22, I have to briefly address colleagues and students at Tel Aviv University (via Zoom), on the occasion of an evening event to celebrate, with a few months delay, my ninetieth birthday. I asked whether, given the situation, I could speak about the political situation and was told: as much as you wish.

I will use the introduction to this diary and quote Curd Jürgens as Udet (in fact, the first to say that line was Max Liebermann on the day of the *Machtergreifung*).

The timing for this event will have depended on the availability of space on a given evening, but it occurred to me that it could also have been determined by the date as such: March 22 is the eve of the day on which, exactly ninety years ago, the Weimar Republic was overthrown by a majority vote of the Reichstag granting full powers to Adolf Hitler. This, of course, should not be considered as a direct allusion to present events, but nonetheless it is helpful to remember how a parliamentary majority can shatter a democratic regime.

Let us return to the present. The settlers' riot in Huwara—or, as it is rightly called, the pogrom in Huwara—should remind us once again of the heart of the problem, that essential aspect many of us refuse to confront directly: the Palestinian issue. It is at the core of our overall conundrum, our political sickness, our long-term social malaise. For tactical reasons, in order not to push away the more right-wing-oriented demonstrators—willing to fight against the judicial reform, but who oppose any common political action with Palestinians—the Palestinian question has been set aside by the opposition. The Palestinians themselves are abstaining from